WeatherSafe | Project Summary

Working agreement for the team

1. Problem statement

People facing harassment, intimidation or threatening situations may not be able to visibly open a safety app, press an SOS button or make a call without drawing attention. WeatherSafe explores a less obvious way to ask trusted people for help.

2. Target users

Primary users: women who may feel unsafe while walking, commuting, travelling, socialising or on dates. The idea could also support others facing similar situations. Secondary users: trusted contacts who receive alerts and check incident updates.

3. What we want to build

A mobile app that looks and works like a normal weather app but includes a hidden safety feature. The user can quietly start an incident using a concealed action. A chosen trusted contact then receives an alert and relevant location/status information.

4. Core workflow

1. Set up trusted contacts and choose what may be shared.
2. Open and use the app as a normal weather app.
3. Use a hidden gesture or other agreed trigger when feeling unsafe.
4. Start an incident and alert the chosen trusted contact.
5. Show location and incident status in a simple trusted-contact view.
6. Allow the user to cancel or end the incident.

5. Initial MVP (must-have features)

- Believable weather app screen and basic weather experience.
- At least one clear, reliable hidden activation method.
- Trusted-contact setup and alert.
- User-controlled location sharing during an incident.
- Simple incident status/timeline for the trusted contact.

6. Stretch goals (only after MVP)

- More gesture options or on-device ML/codeword detection.
- Fake incoming call to help the user exit a situation.
- Optional evidence capture, subject to privacy and legal review.
- Different incident levels and more advanced alert rules.
- Location-based triggers or advanced monitoring, only if safe and justified.

7. Technical and safety direction

Investigate Flutter or React Native, on-device ML and secure communication (possibly WebRTC/P2P). These are options to test, not confirmed solutions. Protect location and other sensitive data through consent, encryption, minimal collection and access control. Research GDPR, false alerts, mobile background limits and misuse risks.

8. What success looks like now

For this three-week phase, deliver research-backed requirements, a clickable UI mock-up showing both the user and trusted-contact journeys, a presentation outline, and team Mahara evidence. This is a university prototype concept, not a finished emergency-response service.

9. Team decision / scope rule

Build and demonstrate the core flow first: weather screen → hidden trigger → incident → trusted-contact alert/view. Keep extra features out of the MVP until research and technical tests show they are realistic, safe and useful.